resource. You use different capabilities to access different resources.

- A token will typically be short-lived as it conveys wide-ranging access to a user's account. A capability on the other hand can live longer as it has a much narrower scope for abuse.

REST already has a standard format for identifying resources, the URI, so this is the natural representation of a capability for a REST API. A capability represented as a URI is known as a *capability URI*. Capability URIs are widespread on the web, in the form of links sent in password reset emails, GitHub Gists, and document sharing as in the Dropbox example.

> **DEFINITION** A ***capability URI*** (or ***capability URL***) is a URI that both identifies a resource and conveys a set of permissions to access that resource. Typically, a capability URI encodes an unguessable token into some part of the URI structure.

To create a capability URI, you can combine a normal URI with a security token. There are several ways that you can do this, as shown in figure 9.2.